

Ἀριστείδης ὁ ῥήτωρ

Sacred Words and the Orations of Aristides the Orator

eul_aid: qwm

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Ἀττικίζουσα [Atticizing](#)
Domain: Ῥητορική [Oratory](#)
Format: Λόγος [Oration](#)

Aelius Aristides was a Greek orator and author of the Roman imperial period, living from about 117 to 181 CE. He is considered a leading figure of the Second Sophistic, a cultural movement focused on reviving classical Greek language and learning. Born into a wealthy family in Mysia, he received an elite education in rhetoric.

His life was famously dominated by chronic illness, which he documented in great detail in his autobiographical Sacred Tales. These writings describe his long sickness, dreams, and the treatments he received from the god Asclepius at healing sanctuaries. Despite his poor health, Aristides maintained an active career as a practicing orator. His surviving works include 55 orations, ranging from ceremonial display speeches to political appeals. One of his most notable achievements was successfully persuading Emperor Marcus Aurelius to fund the reconstruction of Smyrna after a devastating earthquake in 178 CE. Other important works include a panegyric To Rome, praising the empire, and the Panathenaic Oration, a lengthy tribute to Athens that imitates classical Athenian style.

According to modern scholars, Aristides holds a dual significance. First, his formal orations are masterful examples of the period's rhetorical art and its deep engagement with the classical past. Second, his Sacred Tales provide an unparalleled personal account of illness, religious healing, and dream interpretation in the ancient world, offering unique insights into ancient medicine and spirituality. His works were highly valued in later centuries as models of pure Attic Greek prose.

Works (57)

- Προσφωνητικός Σμυρναϊκός · [Address to Smyrna](#) · 5 passages
- Συμβουλευτικός περὶ τοῦ μὴ δεῖν κωμῳδεῖν · [Advisory-Not Needing to Comedize](#) · 9 passages
- Κατὰ τῶν ἐξορχουμένων · [Against the Dancers](#) · 16 passages
- Συμμαχικός Α. · [Allied A.](#) · 14 passages
- Συμμαχικός Β. · [Allied B. To Thebans-the Alliance](#) · 15 passages
- Ἀσκληπιάδαι · [Asclepiads](#) · 6 passages
- Ἀθηνᾶ · [Athena](#) · 9 passages
- Ἀπελλᾶ γενεθλιακός · [Birthday of Apellas](#) · 8 passages
- Διόνυσος · [Dionysus](#) · 4 passages
- Αἰγύπτιος · [Egyptian](#) · 34 passages
- Ἐλευσίνιος · [Eleusinian](#) · 5 passages
- Πρεσβευτικός πρὸς Ἀχιλλέα · [Embassy to Achilles](#) · 13 passages

- Ῥώμης ἐγκώμιον · encom of Rome · 32 passages
- Πανηγυρικός ἐν Κυζίκῳ περὶ τοῦ ναοῦ · Festival Speech in Cyzicus-the Temple · 12 passages
- Πανηγυρικός ἐπὶ τῷ ὕδατι ἐν Περγάμῳ · Festival Speech-the Water in Pergamum · 1 passages
- Ἐπὶ Ἀλεξάνδρῳ ἐπιτάφιος · Funeral OratiAlexander · 11 passages
- εἰς Ἑτεωνέα ἐπικήδειος · Funeral Oration for Eteoneus · 6 passages
- Ἴσθμικός εἰς Ποσειδῶνα · Heracles · 6 passages
- Ὑπὲρ τῆς πρὸς Ἀθηναίους εἰρήνης · In Favor of Peace with the Athenians · 8 passages
- Ὑπὲρ τῆς πρὸς Λακεδαιμονίους εἰρήνης · In Favor of Peace with the Lacedaemonians · 9 passages
- Ἴσθμικός εἰς Ποσειδῶνα · Isthmian to Poseidon · 12 passages
- Ἐπιστολὴ περὶ Σμύρνης · Letter-Smyrna · 5 passages
- Λευκτρικός Α. · Leuctrian A. In Favor of Lacedaemonians First · 20 passages
- Λευκτρικός Β. · Leuctrian B. In Favor of Thebans First · 21 passages
- Λευκτρικός Γ. · Leuctrian C. In Favor of Lacedaemonians Second · 10 passages
- Λευκτρικός Δ. · Leuctrian D. In Favor of Thebans Second · 9 passages
- Λευκτρικός Ε. · Leuctrian E. In Favor of Helping Neither · 12 passages
- Μονωδία ἐπὶ Σμύρνη · Monody-Smyrna · 4 passages
- Περὶ ὁμονοίας ταῖς πόλεσιν · On Concord in the Cities · 22 passages
- Περὶ πολιτικοῦ λόγου · On Political Discourse · 195 passages
- Περὶ τοῦ πέμπειν βοήθειαν τοῖς ἐν Σικελίᾳ · On Sending Aid to Those in Sicily · 13 passages
- Περὶ τοῦ παραφθέγματος · On the Paraphrase · 37 passages
- Παλινωδία ἐπὶ Σμύρνη καὶ τῷ ταύτης ἀνοικισμῷ · Palinode-Smyrna and Its Rebuilding · 7 passages
- Παναθηναϊκός · Panathenaic · 106 passages
- Ποιητικὰ Ἀποσπάσματα · Poetic Fragments · 4 passages
- Σμυρναϊκός πολιτικός · Political Speech for Smyrna · 7 passages
- Ῥοδιακός · Rhodian · 19 passages
- Ἱεροὶ λόγοι πέμπτος · Sacred Words Fifth · 15 passages
- Ἱεροὶ λόγοι πρῶτος · Sacred Words First · 18 passages
- Ἱεροὶ λόγοι τέταρτος · Sacred Words Fourth · 26 passages
- Ἱεροὶ λόγοι δεύτερος · Sacred Words Second · 19 passages
- Ἱεροὶ λόγοι ἕκτος · Sacred Words Sixth · 1 passages
- Ἱεροὶ λόγοι τρίτος · Sacred Words Third · 12 passages
- Λαλιά εἰς Ἀσκληπιόν · Speech to Asclepius · 5 passages
- Πρὸς Καπίτωνα · To Capitulinus · 16 passages
- Πρὸς Δημοσθένη περὶ ἀτελείας · To Demosthenes-Exemption · 33 passages
- Πρὸς Λεπτίνην ὑπὲρ ἀτελείας · To Leptines in Favor of Exemption · 86 passages
- Πρὸς Πλάτωνα ὑπὲρ τῶν τεττάρων · To Plato in Favor of the Four · 200 passages
- Πρὸς Πλάτωνα περὶ ῥητορικῆς · To Plato-Rhetoric · 115 passages
- Εἰς τὸν Σάραπιν · To Serapis · 10 passages
- Εἰς τὸ Αἰγαῖον πέλαγος · To the Aegean Sea · 5 passages
- Εἰς βασιλέα · To the King · 12 passages
- Εἰς τὸ ἐναντίον · To the Opposite · 16 passages
- Ῥοδίοις περὶ ὁμονοίας · To the Rhodians-Concord · 15 passages
- Εἰς τὸ φρέαρ τοῦ Ἀσκληπιοῦ · To the Well of Asclepius · 5 passages

- [Πρὸς τοὺς αἰτιωμένους ὅτι μὴ μελετῶν](#) · [To Those Accusing of Not Practicing](#) · 9 passages
- [Εἰς Δία](#) · [To Zeus](#) · 8 passages